

User Guide

AI-powered analysis of your Qlik Sense charts, driven by Anthropic's Claude

Product	Anthropic AI Assistant for Qlik Sense (client-managed on Windows)
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Asking a question sends the selected chart's data out of your environment to an LLM (Anthropic, via the proxy), unless you pick a local model, in which case the data stays on your own infrastructure. Do not use it with sensitive, regulated, or personal data without explicit authorization.

1. Introduction: what it is

The Anthropic AI Assistant is a Qlik Sense visualization extension that puts an AI assistant panel on your dashboards. The flow is simple: select up to 5 charts, type a question in plain language, and get an analysis written by Claude.

- On the first question of a session, the extension also sends the app's data model structure (table names, field names, and master items) so Claude can interpret the chart in context.
- It runs on client-managed Qlik Sense on Windows (Desktop and Enterprise/QSEoW), version 3.0 or later. Qlik Sense Cloud is out of scope on purpose, since Cloud already ships its own native AI assistants.
- The extension holds no API key in the browser. Every request goes through a hardened proxy that keeps the key server-side and authenticates the caller's Qlik session. The proxy is mandatory: without it, the extension does not work.
- You choose the model right in the panel (Haiku, Sonnet, Opus), including a local model running through Ollama, in which case the chart data never leaves your infrastructure.

2. Prerequisites

- Client-managed Qlik Sense on Windows (Desktop or Enterprise/QSEoW), version 3.0 or later.
- The hardened proxy, deployed and reachable same-site with the Qlik hub (see proxy/README.md). The proxy holds the Anthropic API key and validates the Qlik session; version 2.0.0 or later.
- The browser must be able to reach the proxy's URL over HTTPS with a certificate it trusts, ideally issued by your internal CA, or the development certificate that proxy/scripts/setup.ps1 generates.
- For local models: an Ollama server running, with the proxy's /api/ollama route configured.

3. Installation

Qlik Sense Desktop (Windows)

- Unzip the extension package into %USERPROFILE%\Documents\Qlik\Sense\Extensions\AnthropicExtension\, so that AnthropicExtension.qext sits directly in that folder, then restart Qlik Sense Desktop.

Qlik Sense Enterprise on Windows (QSEoW)

- In the QMC, go to Extensions, Import, and upload the .zip file. The extension becomes available immediately.

Adding the assistant to a sheet

- Open an app in edit mode, find the “Anthropic AI Assistant” visualization, and drag it onto the sheet. A floating button appears anchored in the bottom-right corner, which expands into a panel when clicked.
- The object should only be added once per app: a second, unconfigured object can override the first one's settings (see section 7).

4. Initial configuration (properties panel)

In the object's properties panel, under “Anthropic AI Settings”, configure:

Property	Description
Default model	The model each session starts with: “Haiku 4.5 (fast, low cost)” (default), “Sonnet 5 (balanced)”, “Opus 5 (most capable)”, or a local model (Ministral 3 8B / 3B via Ollama). Switch it any time with “Pick model” in the panel.
Proxy URL	REQUIRED for Claude models. The hardened proxy's Anthropic route, e.g. https://your-qlik-host:3000/api/anthropic . Blank hides the Claude models from both this dropdown and the in-panel picker.
Local model URL	REQUIRED for local models. The proxy's Ollama route, e.g. https://your-qlik-host:3000/api/ollama . Must be HTTPS on QSEoW. Blank hides the local models the same way.
Log level	Browser-console verbosity: ERROR (errors only), WARN (errors and warnings), INFO (plus one line per handled request), or DEBUG (plus a trace of every proxy call). Lower it to WARN/ERROR once past testing.
Version	Read-only field: “Version 0.5.5 · build 45”.

There is no “API key” property anymore: the key lives only on the proxy. If neither URL is configured, the panel shows a “Configuration problem” notice explaining what to fix.

5. Panel walkthrough

- Green floating button (bottom-right corner): opens and closes the panel.
- “AI Assistant” header with a close button.
- “Chart Selection”: “Add Chart” and “Clear All” buttons, plus chips for the selected charts, up to 5.
- “Ask about your data.”: the text area where you type your question.
- “Pick model”: an in-panel model switcher; switching clears the current conversation, since history does not carry meaning across models.
- “Advanced Options”: data, analysis-style, and streaming settings (collapsible).
- “AI Conversation”: the conversation thread, with a “New chat” button.
- “Stop” button: replaces “Submit” while an answer is generating; it halts inference itself, not just the UI.
- Panel footer: “v0.5.5 · build 45 · by mabaeyens”.

6. Using it, step by step

6.1 Select one or more charts

- Click “Add Chart”; the button becomes “Cancel” and selection mode turns on.
- Click a chart on the dashboard: it appears as a chip with its title and an “x” to remove it.

- You can select up to 5 charts. Reaching the limit shows “Maximum 5 charts.”.
- “Clear All” removes every chart. With nothing selected, the hint reads “No charts selected”.

6.2 Ask a question

- Type your question in “Ask about your data.” (e.g. “what are the top 5 customers by revenue?”).
- Click “Submit”. The button is disabled while a request is in flight, or when no chart is selected.
- While Claude answers, the status reads “Thinking...”. With streaming on (the default), the answer appears token by token.

6.3 Read the answer

- The answer appears in the thread, rendered from Markdown (headings, lists, bold, code) and sanitized before display.
- Every answer has a “Copy” button that copies the text to the clipboard, and a footer naming the model that wrote it.

6.4 Follow-up conversation

- You can keep asking: the extension keeps conversation memory (up to 12 turns; the oldest are dropped).
- “New chat” resets the conversation (keeps the selected charts). The app context is always resent with the first question of the new conversation.
- Switching model with “Pick model” asks for confirmation, because the conversation is reset.

6.5 Advanced options

Expand “Advanced Options” to tune what data is sent and the analysis style:

- Data Settings: “Include app context (data model) on first message”, “Stream the answer as it is generated”, “Max data rows” (default 1000; range 10-10000), “Include numeric values”, “Simplify data structure”, “Include dimensions”, “Include measures” (all on by default).
- Analysis Style: “Business analyst (default)”, “Technical analyst”, “Executive summary”, or “Custom” (with a text area for your own system instructions).

6.6 Suggest a chart

- After receiving an analysis, click “Suggest a chart” (the AI proposes a Qlik chart; the status reads “Designing a chart...”).
- A live preview of the proposed chart is shown.
- With the sheet in edit mode, click “Add to sheet” to add it. Outside edit mode you’ll see “Open the sheet in Edit mode to add charts.”. If the sheet is full, “Create a new sheet” is offered.
 - Supported types: bar, line, combo, pie, scatter, table, pivot-table, KPI, histogram, distribution, boxplot, waterfall, treemap, gauge, mekko, and bullet. Map visualizations are not supported.

7. Messages and warnings

Situation	Message / behavior
Neither Proxy URL nor Local model URL configured	“Configuration problem, no endpoint configured” notice in the panel. It re-evaluates on every render and clears itself as soon as either one is set.
Large data (> ~65 KB)	Confirmation dialog: “The selected chart data is about N KB... Send it anyway?”. You can cancel and filter with selections, or continue.
Exceeds the context window	“This request is about N tokens, which exceeds the ... context window...”. “OK” truncates the chart data to fit; “Cancel” stops the send.
Payload too large (> 1 MB)	Blocked client-side before sending, to avoid a less friendly 413 rejection from the proxy.

Situation	Message / behavior
Proxy busy (429 / 503)	A rate-limit or full-queue message; the proxy enforces admission control and a bounded queue.
Adding a chart outside edit mode	"Open the sheet in Edit mode to add charts."
Session error (401 / 403)	The proxy could not validate the Qlik session. Check that you're reaching the proxy by the Qlik host name (not localhost), so the session cookie is actually sent.
A model is missing from the picker	By design: that model's backend (Proxy URL or Local model URL) is blank.

8. Best practices and privacy

- Filter data with selections before sending: it reduces tokens, cost, and latency, and avoids exceeding the model's context window.
- Remember that, with hosted models (Claude), the chart data leaves the environment toward an external LLM through the proxy, along with real table/field names and master-item expressions on the first question.
- With a local model (Minstral via Ollama) the data stays on your infrastructure, useful for data that must not leave the perimeter.
- The API key is no longer in the browser: it lives only on the proxy (a server-side environment variable). The proxy authenticates the caller through their Qlik session.
- Do not use the extension with sensitive, regulated, or personal data unless that data egress is explicitly permitted in your organization.

9. Where to get help

This is an independent project: support is provided through GitHub Issues, not through Qlik's own support channels. Before opening an issue, check TROUBLESHOOTING.md in the repository, which covers the most common problems with step-by-step instructions.